

**THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS**

PMGM7002 Managing Across Cultures 2025-2026

GENERAL INFORMATION	
Instructor: Dr. Yiwen ZHANG Email: zhangyiwen@hku.hk Office: KK 716 Phone: 3917 1615 Consultation times: Monday 10:00 – 12:00, 14:00 – 18:00 (By appointment only) Teaching Assistants: Section A/B/C: Connie TAI cntai@hku.hk Section D/E/F: Olivia LI kongqili@hku.hk Pre-requisites: [None] Co-requisites: [None] Mutually exclusive: N/A Recommended Reference Book: <i>Thomas, D.C., & Peterson, M. F. (2018). Cross-Cultural Management: Essential Concepts. (4th ed). Publisher: Sage.</i>	
COURSE DESCRIPTION	
The trend of globalization in business requires organizational members, especially managers, to effectively accomplish international assignments, to collaborate with and lead cross-cultural teams, and to manage the increasingly diverse workforce. Therefore, managers need to acquire cultural competencies that go beyond traditional managerial competencies. We will focus on organizational behavior and human resource management issues in multinational organizations.	
COURSE OBJECTIVES	
1. Introduce the key concepts and main theoretical frameworks of culture 2. Introduce how cultural differences may impact the management of individuals, teams, and organizations. 3. Introduce effective human resource management practice in multinational organizations. 4. Develop students' teamwork and leadership skills 5. Develop students' critical and creative thinking abilities 6. Develop students' cultural awareness and intelligence	
PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES	
PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the programme discipline PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership PLO4: Developing global outlook PLO5: Mastering communication skills	
COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES	
Course Learning Outcomes	Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes

CLO1: Demonstrate relevant knowledge, skills, and abilities when presented with cross-cultural management problems in multinational organizations		PLO 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	
CLO2: Demonstrate understanding and respect for culture difference		PLO 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	
CLO3: Apply theoretical frameworks in analyzing culture and related management problems		PLO 1, 2, 3, 4	
CLO4: Provide critical and creative solutions for cross-cultural management problems		PLO 1, 2, 3, 4	
CLO5: Prepare and present structured presentations and reports		PLO 3, 5	
COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES			
Course Teaching and Learning Activities		Expected contact hour	Study Load (% of study)
T&L1. Interactive lectures		25	21%
T&L2. In-class activities		10	8%
T&L3. Video clips		5	4%
T&L4. Group case analyses		30	25%
T&L5. Group Project		30	25%
T&L6. Individual Project		20	17%
Total		120	100%
Assessment Methods			
Brief Description (Optional)		Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. Attendance and participation		20%	CLO1, 2, 3
A2. Group Case Analyses		30%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6
A3. Group Final Project		30%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6
A4. Individual Project		20%	CLO 1, 2, 3, 5, 6
Total		100%	
STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT			
Course Grade Descriptors			
A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • High participation in interactive lectures and case discussions • Present arguments that demonstrate critical and creative thinking • Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the assignments with very good analytical and problem-solving skills		
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Good participation in interactive lectures and case discussions • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve a standard of good performance in the exams with good analytical and problem-solving skills		
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Some participation in interactive lectures and case discussions • Present arguments in an acceptable manner • Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the exams with acceptable analytical and problem-solving skills		

D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the exams with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem-solving skills • Marginally acceptable performance in assignments
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the exams with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem-solving skills • Poor performance in assignments
Assessment Rubrics for Attendance and Participation Attendance will be taken for the lectures, case discussions, and presentations. Discussion and sharing in class will be considered in assigning points for attendance and individual participation. Unlike many other business courses you have taken, this course emphasizes on applying management theories from the textbooks to the analyses of real-world issues in international business practice. So active involvement in class, especially in case discussions, is required. Below is a list of behavioral criteria that will be used in your performance evaluation. • Be a good listener and stay focused in the moment. • Make comments that are relevant to the discussion at hand. Do not take the discussion backward. Try to interact with your classmates by building on their comments. • Use materials discussed in lectures during the discussion. For example, use a particular theory or model to diagnose a situation and to propose solutions. • Make comments that cut to the core of an issue or problem. The quality of a comment is valued more than the length of it. • Be able to support and defend your solutions/recommendations. • Professionally challenge others' arguments or suggestions if appropriate. • Contribute new ideas rather than repeat what others have been saying. Below are the expectations specific to the course of cross-cultural management: • Be aware of your own cultural values. Your own cultural background and values influence how you perceive and interpret situations. An implicit goal of this class is to help you be self-aware of your own your values and/or biases. • Respect others' contributions. There is no one-best-way in management. Learn from your classmates by active listening. If you cannot understand their answers, speak out and ask. Your questions can help them make their rationale explicit and move the conversation into valuable depth.	
A+, A, A-	• Very active participation in discussions • Always attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • Present arguments that demonstrate a high level of creative and critical thinking • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
B+, B, B-	• Good participation in discussions • Often attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Present arguments that demonstrate a good level of creative and critical thinking • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
C+, C, C-	• Some participation in discussions • Sometimes attend in-class discussions

	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Present arguments that demonstrate some creative and critical thinking • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
D+, D	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Rarely attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Present arguments that demonstrate barely any creative and critical thinking • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
F	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Almost never attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Present arguments that demonstrate no creative or critical thinking • Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late)
Assessment Rubrics for Group Case Analyses and Individual Project Each group will be required to submit one written case analysis report via Moodle before the case is discussed in class (case assignment and due date TBD). Each individual will be required to analyze a designated case at the end of the course and submit a written report via Moodle. Late submission will NOT be accepted or graded. A case analysis report can be no longer than three pages (single-spaced with a font of 12-point Times New Roman, one-inch margin).	
A+, A, A-	• All key management problems are identified • Insightful and detailed analyses • Sufficient support with relevant data/facts • Effective application of management concepts and theories • Well thought-out and feasible recommendations • Excellent writing
B+, B, B-	• Most of the key management problems are identified • Generally insightful and detailed analyses • Appropriate use of relevant data/facts • Acceptable application of management concepts and theories • Generally logical and feasible recommendations • Decent writing.
C+, C, C-	• A few key management problems are identified • Somewhat insightful and detailed analyses • Insufficient use of relevant data/facts • Limited application of management concepts and theories • Mediocre and infeasible recommendations • Marginally acceptable writing.
D+, D	• Less important management problems are identified • Analyses lacking a clear focus and consistency • Limited use of relevant data/facts • Little application of management concepts and theories • Recommendations not well-thought out and not practical • Poor writing.
F	• Key management problems are entirely overlooked • Poor analyses with no consistency in logics • Absence of relevant data/facts • No application of management concepts and theories • Poor recommendations • Unacceptable writing.

Assessment Rubrics for Group Final Project

Students are randomly divided into groups to conduct cross-cultural management-related projects. Each group prepares and makes a 20-minute presentation. The group presentation will be evaluated based on five criteria (i.e., presentation style, content coverage, articulation on critical issues, use of concepts discussed in class, quality of interaction).

A+, A, A-	• Professional presentation style • Comprehensive content coverage • Well-articulated on critical issues • Effective use of management concepts • Quality interaction with audience
B+, B, B-	• Decent presentation style • Appropriate content coverage • Clear discussion of critical issues • Moderately effective use of management concepts • Acceptable interaction with audience.
C+, C, C-	• Mediocre presentation style • Limited content coverage • Marginally acceptable discussion of critical issues • Infrequent use of management concepts • Limited interaction with audience
D+, D	• Weak presentation style • Key content omitted • Unclear focus on critical issues • Very limited use of management concepts • Poor interaction with audience
F	• Unacceptable presentation style • Questionable content coverage • Omitting critical issues • Zero use of management concepts • No interaction with audience

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

Session 1:	Syllabus & Introduction; What is culture?
Session 2:	How to analyze culture? Conceptual models; Culture shock and expatriate adjustment
Session 3:	Case 1 discussion; Motivation across cultures
Session 4:	Case 2 discussion; Ethics and decision making
Session 5:	Case 3 discussion; Developing a global team
Session 6:	Team and leadership simulation
Session 7:	Case 4 discussion; Leadership: A global perspective
Session 8:	Case 5 discussion; International Human Resource Management (1)
Session 9:	Case 6 discussion; International Human Resource Management (2)
Session 10:	Group Presentations

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

Plagiarism and copying of copyright materials are serious offences and may lead to disciplinary actions. You should read the chapters on "Plagiarism" and "Copyright" in the Undergraduate/Postgraduate Handbook for details. You are strongly advised to read the booklet entitled "What is Plagiarism?" which was distributed to you upon your admission into the University, a copy of which can be found at www.hku.hk/plagiarism. A booklet entitled "Plagiarism and How to Avoid it" is also available from the Main Library

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